I vividly recall my first experience of heavy snowfall at my piquet. I had gone to visit one of my forward posts, situated deep in the gorge but on our side of the Kishenganga river. It was a classic case of eyeball-to-eyeball confrontation separated by a 100-odd metres with the river in between. Each side could watch the activities of the other. A visit by the company commander was an important event and the Pakistanis were keenly watching the happenings. I always insisted on having a 'Sainik Sammelan', an address to the soldiers, followed by a regimental song and battle cry, and a community lunch during such trips. This raised the morale and level of motivation of all ranks and helped me to create esprit de corps among my team. This became my leadership style. It was a gruelling one-and-a-half hour climb back to my company HQ and there was already some snow in places on the track. Besides, it started snowing as we reached the half-way point. The final ascent to the top was very steep as usual. I was quite fatigued by the time I finally reached my bunker. A hot bath and a large peg of rum along with the usual snacks relaxed me.

The next morning I was greeted by a thick carpet of three-to-four-feet of virgin snow all around. It was a complete 'whiteout', something I hadn't witnessed before. The purity of the white colour of the snow is beyond comparison. The deodar branches were drooping with the weight of lumps of soft snow, many having collapsed and fallen to the ground, unable to bear the weight. With a thud, a huge white ball would suddenly fall off these trees and strike the earth, as I walked around the post. It was the most fascinating and beautiful sight I had ever seen.

In the summer of 1979, Rohini and the children came on a month's vacation in Tangdhar. Lieutenant Colonel Dhillon told me that I could spend time with my wife and kids, but would have to be back in my piquet at night. So, it was a lot of trekking for me those days. Coming down to the Battalion HQ, I used to literally jog and reach in 45 minutes or so. Going back was tough. Rohini felt bad for me, but it was better than being far away in Jalandhar. At least we could